Canva Seamless Repeat Card

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The offset arithmetic, the spec, and the seam test. Verified 5 October 2026.

THE ONE RULE

The canvas edge is a CROP, not a wrap.

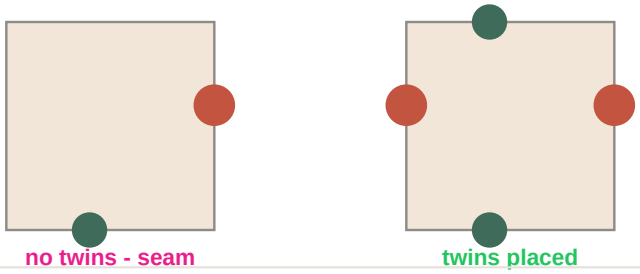
Anything pushed past the edge is cut there and nothing continues on the other side. So every element touching an edge needs a twin, placed by TYPED coordinates. Canva Help Centre: X and Y are the distance in pixels from the TOP-LEFT corner, set under Position > Advanced.

```
crosses the RIGHT edge   ->   twin at  X - canvas width
crosses the BOTTOM edge  ->   twin at  Y - canvas height
```

(Mirror it for the left and top edges: X + width, Y + height.) The OTHER coordinate stays IDENTICAL.

A motif in a CORNER needs FOUR copies: the original, X-width, Y-height, and BOTH.

Miss the fourth and you get a seam at every corner point - the most noticeable kind there is.



THE SEAM TEST - THE ONLY HONEST CHECK

You cannot judge a seam inside Canva: no tile preview, no offset preview, no wrap mode. Export the tile as a PNG, make a second design at exactly TWICE the tile size, and drop the PNG in four times - typed, not dragged:

```
X=0  Y=0     X=tile  Y=0     X=0  Y=tile     X=tile  Y=tile
```

Look at the two joins. Fix it in the ORIGINAL, export again, re-test - never patch the proof.

A hairline of white means the background does not overhang. A sliced motif means no twin, or its other coordinate was changed. A light-to-dark band means a gradient background - its dark end meets the next tile's light end.

THE SPEC - SPOONFLOWER, AS AN EXAMPLE

"Your files should be a JPG or PNG, saved at your preferred print dimensions and 150 DPI, and under 40 MB." They convert everything to 150 DPI on upload, so the PHYSICAL repeat size is your decision and the resolution is not. They print in sRGB, not CMYK - and Canva works in RGB anyway.

"Be sure any background colors in your file extend to the edge of the file, otherwise the design will look broken up into separate squares as opposed to a seamless repeating layout."

`inches x 150 = pixels`

2 in repeat	**300 x 300 px**
8 in repeat	**1200 x 1200 px**
12 in repeat	**1800 x 1800 px**

Other marketplaces differ - check your own spec page.

SEVEN CHECKS BEFORE YOU LIST IT

* The background covers the whole canvas and overhangs every side
* Every edge-crossing motif has an exact twin - typed, not dragged
* Every corner motif has all four copies
* **You have tiled it two by two and looked at BOTH joins**
* The pixels match the physical repeat at your marketplace's DPI
* It is under their file size ceiling
* Every motif came from a Canva search filtered to Free

The fourth is the only one that actually proves the first three. Arithmetic is a claim; tiling is the evidence.

Sources: Canva Help Centre (Move elements in your design); Spoonflower support.